

This week's פרשיות are פרשת וילך, and include פרשת פנחס, the shortest פרשה in the Torah. Nevertheless, it has a powerhouse full of wonderful things to learn, one of which is what we will do now from the Torah. In וילך, גאון brought down a powerful pasuk that says: וַיֹּאמֶר ה' אֶל מֹשֶׁה הֵן קָרְבָנוּ יָמֶיךָ לְמוֹת קָרָא אֶת הַיְהוָה שֵׁם הַפָּסוּק לֵאמֹר פָּסוּק יִי, מדרש ילקוט, brought down in התורה, says that the day that משה רבינו was going to be נפטר, Hashem's שכינה moved over to Yehoshua and was speaking to Yehoshua. משה - Moshe asked Yehoshua: - מה אמר לך? - What did Hashem tell you? - Yehoshua's answer to Moshe was, "אמר לו יהושע, וכל ארבעים שנה שאלתי אותך מה דיבר ה'?" Immediately משה רבינו said, טוב אלה, - Better to die a thousand times than to have a moment of קנאה. A פלאידיג from beginning to the end.

The first question is, is this the way that Yehoshua could possibly speak to משה רבינו under any circumstances? That's the obvious question. We are amazed to hear such a statement. And the second question is, what in fact did הקדוש ברוך הוא tell Yehoshua that was so vital, so important?

The answers in a way that only he could. He wanted to pass away very calmly, with a clear mind, and willingly. We know that Moshe Rabbeinu davened 515 times. One of his requests was that if indeed the time had come for Yehoshua to take over leadership - since two kings cannot rule at the same time - then let Yehoshua be the Rebbe and Moshe be the talmid. “At least”, Moshe asked, “allow me to go into the land of Israel so I can perform the mitzvot there. I don’t want to die before I have this opportunity.”

This will not be easy for him. In fact, he will not be able to tolerate it at all. Therefore, as usual, the two קשיית answer each other. What did Hashem tell Yehoshua? Hashem told him: when Moshe asks you “What did Hashem say to you?” you should respond, “And in all the forty years, did I ever ask you what Hashem said?” He was quoting Hashem’s words exactly, word for word.

So for one split second, a millisecond, משה רבינו would think Yehoshua is saying such a thing, and he'll say to himself, I'd rather die than have קנאה. משה רבינו himself quickly realized that that's exactly what Hashem said to Yehoshua. But that one moment was enough to give him the קנאה to no longer want to go along with his הוה אמינא to be the talmid.

Then he has at the end of this וילנא גאון דפח"ה. I did not know what those four letters were, so I asked a few people and ended up calling R' Hershel Schachter, who told me, and I wrote it in my sefer here, דפח"ה is דברי פי חכם חן - The words of a wise man are very pleasant, are very beautiful.

So this is a tremendous **גאון וילנא** on the **פרשה** teaches us that everything is for our own good. **הקדוש ברוך**, **פרקי אבות**, we have to be **מקבל** it. As it says in **אבות**, we have to be **מקבל** it with **שמחה**. **אם ירצה ה'**, we should have **געזונט** **יאר** **א**, **daven** that Hashem should not send us **בסיונות**, and in fact give us **אריכות ימים** **נחת** from the **קינדער**, opportunities to do more and more **מצוות**, and that we should be **זוכה** to see **ביאת גואל צדק** this year.

